poor people could get no bread at all. There are immense stocks of grain in the districts near this, a great part of which belong to the government, this grain they are bringing in, so I expect we shall have a fall presently. Grain is still most cheap and plentiful in many of the provinces of Persia, but carriage is so expensive in this country where we have no made roads and canals, that the transport often costs far more than the grain is worth.

Our little girl Fanny has had the small pox and thank God has got well over it, it has been an anxious time for Annah and she has born it remarkably well, as she nurses the child herself and as the attack was a severe one, you may imagine what she has had to go through.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO HENRY BURGESS] *Tehran, February 26, 1855*

Since writing to you last month your most kind affectionate and fatherly letter, in answer to mine of the 19th Octr praying you to take care of my dear wife and child in case of your surviving me has arrived. How shall I describe to you the emotions this letter inspired in me, thankfulness to God for having given me so good and kind a father and gratitude to you were my predominant feelings. You appear hurt that I should for a moment have doubted your being, in the event of my wife being left a widow, a kind hearted protector to her, the feeling I had in writing that letter arose from another cause, that is the dislike I had of burthening you with such a serious charge; it being the sacred duty of a son, after he has arrived at the age of manhood to aid assist and support his father. Instead of being burthensome to him, the son ought to labour and undergo privations that the father may live in ease and comfort. How different have been our positions, whilst you have been undergoing privations, I have been enjoying many comparative luxuries.

You will be very glad to learn that, thank God, my health has somewhat improved, I am now altho' still very weak, able to put my horse into a trot or canter without the fear of falling off, a thing I have not done for many months, the disease still continues but its bad symptoms are much mitigated.

I have given in my petition for leave to the Prime Minister, it is addressed direct to the king, and I was about to take it to him direct, but was advised to present it first to the minister. He has agreed to it verbally, but I shall not think myself secure until the King has agreed to my petition and my leave is published in the Gazette. Mr Thomson put in a kind word for me to day in asking the minister to allow me something for my expenses to England, the minister laughed and said "this is rather too bad not only are we going to pay a man for sitting in his house and doing nothing but you ask us to pay his carriage home into the bargain; however tell Burgess to follow up his petition himself, and

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